

APRICOTS *Prunus armeniaca*

Homegrown apricots are a delicious treat—perfect for eating fresh or for cooking or making jam. Because of their Asian origins, apricots will need adequate frost protection during colder months, and may need help with pollination. Since they are self-fertile you will only need one tree to produce a crop, and if you choose a dwarfing variety you can harvest fresh, flavorful fruit even from a tiny space.

	SPRING	SUMMER	FALL	WINTER
PLANT				
HARVEST				

PLANTING

Apricot trees prefer a warm, sheltered site—a south-facing wall is ideal, although they will grow happily in a greenhouse or in a large container that can be moved under cover in colder months. As with all fruit trees, if you are buying them container-grown, ensure that they have not become pot-bound.

Plant trees in fall–early winter. Dig in plenty of well-rotted manure or compost a few months before planting. Apricots will grow well in most fertile, well-drained soils, but prefer a pH of between 6.7–7.5. Attach some supports if growing your apricot against a wall. Stake young trees, and ensure that they are kept well-watered.



Colorful buds break in early spring.

CROP CARE

Apricot trees are fully hardy, but since they produce blossoms very early in the year—even as early as late winter—they may still need protection against frost. Move container-grown plants indoors, and cover wall-trained trees with fleece (see right). If you are growing your apricots indoors, or where they will receive few insect pollinators,